

Nate Young

Senior QA Lead

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Bloomington, MN, 55425

Quality Engineering leader with extensive experience driving large-scale testing initiatives, release reliability, and quality strategy for complex, continuously delivered software products. Expert in designing scalable test processes, leading cross-functional teams, and improving operational efficiency across distributed systems. Proven ability to manage multi-team QA efforts, coordinate vendor resources, build automation strategies, and champion process improvements that reduce risk and accelerate delivery. Adept at data-driven decision-making, customer-focused quality validation, and developing future QA leadership talent.

Technical Proficiencies & Skills

Tools:	Jira, Confluence, SQL, Git, Postman, Testrail, Selenium, Python
Testing Domains:	Functional, Integration, Web/Mobile/Desktop, System Validation, Performance, Regression, User Acceptance, Risk-Based Testing
Leadership & Strategy:	QA Roadmaps, Test Strategy/Planning, SDLC, CI/CD Alignment, Process Improvement, Vendor Management, Team Development

Career Experience

General Dynamics Mission Systems, Bloomington, MN

05/2025 – present

Networking Software Test Lead

- Lead testing for embedded networking software product, owning test planning, automation strategy, requirements-based validation, and measurement of quality metrics.
- Define automation opportunities, lead benchmarking efforts on commercial hardware, and coordinate test materials and budgeting for a multi-disciplinary engineering team.
- Oversee execution of test cycles, enhance test coverage, and ensure compliance with internal quality and reliability standards.

Blizzard Entertainment, Irvine, CA

04/2024 – 05/2025

Senior Test Lead

- Led QA for continuous product updates in a large-scale SaaS-like environment, managing analysts and directing vendor testing teams to ensure release readiness across multiple platforms.
- Owned end-to-end QA program management: test strategy, estimation, execution oversight, triage, risk assessment, and release reporting for recurring software deployments.
- Conducted process audits and spearheaded continuous improvement initiatives to increase efficiency, reduce defect leakage, and standardize best practices across QA departments.
- Facilitated release coordination across multiple engineering and product teams; hosted retrospectives, knowledge transfers, and quality sign-off reviews.
- Developed leadership training documentation and mentored emerging QA leads to strengthen the organization's internal management pipeline.

Achievement:

- Directed release activities for major multi-team software updates with highly compressed timelines.

Bungie Inc, Seattle, WA (Remote in Anaheim, CA)

10/2021 – 10/2023

QA Lead

- Managed QA for ongoing live-service software products, overseeing a team of analysts and contractors responsible for validating complex, distributed features and integrated systems.
- Built comprehensive test strategies and requirements frameworks; drove test planning, data collection, risk

triage, and cross-team issue prioritization in a rapid delivery environment.

- Partnered with engineering teams to design automation tools and streamline validation of recurring workflows.
- Created performance evaluation systems, conducted hiring, and coached analysts across multiple teams to develop technical and leadership capabilities.

Achievement:

- Redesigned user feedback and evaluation processes, reducing cycle time and improving developer satisfaction by 20%.
- Achieved a 15% reduction in redundant test cycles through process optimization and smarter resource allocation.

Blizzard Entertainment, Irvine, CA
Test Lead

05/2021 – 10/2021

- Led QA for a high-traffic desktop application (equivalent to a large consumer-facing SaaS application), validating core functionality, UI/UX flows, integrations, and system behaviors.
- Supported QA for iOS/Android mobile apps, executing test plans for cross-platform releases and contributing to A/B experiment evaluation and user-behavior analysis.

Riot Games, Los Angeles, CA
Quality Engineer/Quality Lead

03/2018 – 11/2020

- Led QA for internal tools and engine-level technologies supporting enterprise-scale development workflows.
- Maintained a complex Jira ecosystem to track technical debt, workflow health, and system reliability across long-running live-service software.
- Created operational plans for external QA vendors and guided cross-team alignment on requirements and quality criteria.

Achievement:

- Rebuilt triage and workflow analytics processes using new user metrics, enhancing 75% of supported engineering workflows.

Modis IT for US Bank, Bloomington, MN
QA Analyst Contractor

05/2017 – 02/2018

- Served as liaison between business test teams and IT engineering, coordinating test activities for large-scale financial software initiatives.

Signature for Wells Fargo, Minneapolis, MN
QA Analyst Contractor

05/2014 – 05/2015

- Performed functional and regression testing for internal web applications within an Agile environment.

Securian Financial, Saint Paul, MN
Quality Assurance Specialist

09/2006 – 05/2014

- Led QA for benefits enrollment and management platforms across web and mobile environments.
- Executed system, integration, smoke, and regression testing using HP ALM, Selenium, and internal frameworks..

Education

Computer Science | 2016 – 2018
Saint Paul College, Saint Paul, MN

Training & Certifications

Certified Tester Foundation Level – American Software Testing Qualifications Board